March Madness Bracket — Scoring & Rules

Overview

Welcome to our class March Madness bracket challenge! Points are awarded by round, with an **extra upset bonus in Round 1**.

Scoring by Round

- **Round 1 (64 teams):** 1 point per correct pick
  - **Upset bonus:** +1 extra point *in Round 1 only* for correctly picking an upset where the **lower seed beats the higher seed**, **excluding 8 vs. 9 games**.
- **Round 2 (32 teams):** 2 points per correct pick
- **Round 3 — Sweet 16:** 3 points per correct pick
- **Round 4 — Elite Eight:** 4 points per correct pick
- **Round 5 — Final Four:** 5 points per correct pick
- **Round 6 — National Championship:** 6 points per correct pick

"Third round = 3 points" and so on—i.e., the point value increases by 1 each round.

Upset Definition (Round 1 only)

- An **upset** is when the **numerically larger seed** defeats the **numerically smaller seed** (e.g., a 12 beats a 5).
- **No upset credit** for 8 vs. 9 matchups.
- Each correctly predicted eligible upset in **Round 1** earns **+1 extra point**.

Quick Examples

Example A — Round 1 upset you called correctly

- You picked a **12** to beat a **5**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 (correct pick) + 1 (upset bonus) = 2 points**

Example B — Round 1 correct pick that is not an upset

- You picked a **2** to beat a **15**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 point** (no upset bonus)

Example C — Sweet 16 correct pick

- You picked the winner of a Sweet 16 game correctly.
- Points: **3 points**

Bonus Points

- **Beat-the-Instructor Bonus:** If your total score **beats my score**, you earn **+1 bonus point**.
- **Placement Bonuses (class leaderboard):**
  - **1st place:** +5
  - **2nd place:** +4
  - **3rd place:** +3

Results

```
library(tidyverse)
library(kableExtra)
results <- read_csv('march_madness_results.csv')
results |>
  kable()
```

Name	Round 32	Upset Points	Sweet 16	Elite 8	Final 4	Championship Game	Champion	Total
Akula, Suhaan	23	1	24	12	12	10	6	88
Palam, Kai	26	1	24	18	8	5	0	82
Yhu, Logan	27	1	26	15	8	5	0	82
Poloskey, Parker	24	0	26	18	8	5	0	81
Kwasniak, Babe	23	1	24	15	8	5	0	76
Bartosh, Braden	25	2	20	12	4	5	6	74
Duong, Ylan	23	2	24	15	8	0	0	72
Chalk	24	0	24	15	8	NA	NA	71
Collins, Ethan	24	2	22	15	8	0	0	71
Teuscher, Kayla	25	1	22	15	8	0	0	71
Jacknewitz, Marisa	26	3	22	6	8	5	0	70
McCauley, Ireland	24	2	16	9	8	5	6	70
O'Keefe, Brendon	23	1	24	12	4	5	0	69
Owen, Jacob	23	1	22	12	4	5	0	67
Yun, Grace	25	1	20	12	4	5	0	67
Gohlich, Tyler	21	1	22	12	4	5	0	65
Ellis, Ethan	22	0	18	12	12	0	0	64
Carmichael, Harry	25	0	18	12	4	5	0	64
Treacy, Keagan	25	2	18	9	4	5	0	63
Coffman, Carter	24	2	20	12	4	0	0	62
Bekele, Brook	23	0	22	12	4	0	0	61

Name	Round 32	Upset Points	Sweet 16	Elite 8	Final 4	Championship Game	Champion	Total
Lai, Sean	26	2	20	6	4	0	0	58
Nordby, Kristian	25	1	16	12	4	0	0	58
West, Jared	24	1	24	9	0	0	0	58
Wurst, Riley	24	0	22	12	0	0	0	58
Catapano, Tyler	25	1	20	8	0	0	0	54
Hyder, Robert	25	2	18	9	0	0	0	54
LTC Pleuss	24	1	20	9	0	0	0	54
Scott, Ryan	20	0	20	3	4	5	0	52
Fellows, Gunnar	21	1	20	9	0	0	0	51
Russell, Owen	21	1	16	12	0	0	0	50
Zick, Christina	24	1	16	9	0	0	0	50
Burtner, Elijah	22	2	12	6	4	0	0	46
Leja, Gabriel	21	3	16	6	0	0	0	46

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